diplomacy now overlaps with policy making. New means of mass communication have also opened up means of direct approach to the people of other countries through other means like propaganda.

Moreover, public opinion has now come to play an important role which, to a large extent, has intruded in the conduct of foreign policy. Diplomacy has ceased to be dynastic or a matter of a handful of people. It has assumed a democratic character where the statesmen have to take the public into confidence.

Further, the structure of international society has also undergone several changes. Europe is no longer the centre of international affairs. Post-Second World War, following massive decolonization of Asian and African countries, the number of independent countries has increased. Therefore, the influence of non-European powers—both Asian and African, has considerably increased; indeed, today they have a greater say in international affairs. Multilateral diplomacy, summit diplomacy or diplomacy by parliamentary procedure have gained importance alongside bilateral diplomacy, and “Open Covenants Openly Arrived” at these summits or conferences show a consuming interest of significant numbers of private citizens and groups. This has been regarded as the “democratization” of foreign policy which is a significant development in this regard. The United Nations has become an important international organization which represents this new genre of diplomacy.

Nicolson has criticized open diplomacy as he says that negotiations require “concessions and counter concessions” and once the news of concessions is divulged, the public might acquire a negative attitude and force the diplomats to abandon the negotiations. Nicolson has also raised serious shortcomings of diplomacy by conference. Such kinds of multilateral diplomacy suffer from several defects and cannot therefore function properly because political statesmen are not often competent to handle diplomatic negotiations. Further, as it involves many people, it fails to solve certain fundamental problems because the members tend to take rigid positions. Still, this new kind of diplomacy is popular and has some basic characteristics as we now discuss.